Selling into the NHS: the five gates

What a product needs before an NHS buyer can say yes. From Lou Hoult, Medical Sales Hub.

GATE 1 · REGULATION

Register with the MHRA

All medical devices, including in vitro diagnostic devices, must be registered with the MHRA before they can be placed on the market in Great Britain. A manufacturer based outside the UK must appoint a single UK Responsible Person, who then registers its devices.

Source: MHRA, Register medical devices to place on the market, updated 16 October 2026.

GATE 1 · REGULATION

CE marking is accepted in Great Britain, for now

CE marked devices may be placed on the Great Britain market until 30 June 2028 or 30 June 2030, depending on device type and the EU legislation. The government will consult on indefinite recognition.

Source: MHRA, Regulating medical devices in the UK, updated 20 February 2026.

GATE 2 · CLINICAL SAFETY

DCB0129 for you, DCB0160 for the NHS body deploying

NHS England's clinical risk management standards for health IT. Compliance with both is mandatory under the Health and Social Care Act 2012.

Source: NHS England Digital, Clinical risk management standards.

GATE 3 · ASSURANCE

Digital Technology Assessment Criteria (DTAC)

Covers clinical safety, data protection, technical security, interoperability, and usability and accessibility. The previous form should not be used from 6 April 2026.

Source: NHS England Digital, DTAC, edited 21 September 2026.

GATE 4 · DATA PROTECTION

Data Security and Protection Toolkit (DSPT)

All organisations with access to NHS patient data and systems must use the toolkit to provide assurance on data security.

Source: Data Security and Protection Toolkit home page.

GATE 5 · EVIDENCE

NICE HealthTech guidance

NICE evaluates digital technologies, diagnostics and medical devices, including AI. Technologies recommended through the National HealthTech Access Programme will receive national NHS funding.

Source: NICE, About HealthTech guidance.

Knowing the gates is half of it. The other half is knowing who buys, through which framework, and when. That's what the Medical Sales Hub maps, with sources.
Book a 20 minute overview: medsalesintelligencehub.co.uk

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